



YOU DON'T REMEMBER YOUR NAME?

SPIRITED AWAY / 2001

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Animation, fantasy

DIRECTOR

Hayao Miyazaki

WRITER

Hayao Miyazaki

STARS

**Rumi Hiiragi, Miyu Irino,
Mari Natsuki**

BEFORE

1979 *The Castle of Cagliostro*, the tale of a clever thief, is Miyazaki's first movie.

1984 *Nausicaä of the Valley of the Wind* stars a pacifist princess in a postapocalyptic world; its success leads to the creation of Studio Ghibli, home to a string of animation hits.

1997 *Princess Mononoke* is Miyazaki's first movie to use computer graphics.

AFTER

2013 *The Wind Rises* tells the fictionalized life story of aircraft designer Jiro Horikoshi.

The animators at Tokyo's Studio Ghibli—chief among them cofounder Hayao Miyazaki—have been making wildly inventive movies since 1986. With a highly distinctive style of animation influenced by the *manga* tradition of Japanese comic books, Studio Ghibli has expanded the tastes of audiences around the world.

Miyazaki's *Spirited Away* brought Ghibli worldwide commercial success, and also acclaim—it was the first foreign-language animation

film to win an Oscar. It was also a masterpiece of its genre, a glorious flight of imagination based on the idea of “the magical doorway” found in much children's fiction. Children often see reality as something to be escaped from, and the genius of *Spirited Away* is allowing the child in everyone to do just that.

After a long train journey, Chihiro and the mysterious No-Face (left) have tea with Zeniba, the twin sister of the greedy and controlling witch Yubaba.

